CASE STUDY

The Check Point Remote Access VPN IKEv1 Authentication Bypass of 2026 (CVE-2026-50751): A Case Study

A TeamStarWolf case study. Published 11 November 2026; every source checked as of that date.

Executive summary

For the teams that run Check Point gateways, the hard part of June 2026 was the hunting window, not the patch. Check Point's research team began chasing suspicious VPN activity on 4 June 2026 [1] (**Confirmed**). By the time it published a hotfix on 8 June, it had traced the first exploitation back to 7 May [1] (**Confirmed**). A gateway patched on the day of disclosure could already have been open for a month (**Inferred** from [1]).

The flaw, CVE-2026-50751, is a logic weakness in how Remote Access and Mobile Access validate certificates during the deprecated IKEv1 key exchange. It lets an unauthenticated remote attacker set up a remote access VPN connection without a valid user password [4] (**Confirmed**). It only works when four configuration conditions all hold [2] (**Confirmed**). CISA added it to the Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) catalog on the day it was published, gave agencies three days, and marked ransomware use as Known [7] (**Confirmed**). Check Point reports one case with confirmed post-compromise activity associated with a Qilin ransomware affiliate, and assesses with medium confidence that the actor is financially motivated and uses Qilin [1] (**Reported**).

Key facts at a glance

Field	Value
Products	Quantum Security Gateway and Spark firewalls running Remote Access or Mobile Access [2] [4]
Flaw	Logic flaw in certificate validation in the deprecated IKEv1 key exchange; CWE-287 Improper Authentication (CNA, NVD and KEV) [4] [5] [7]
Precondition	All four: Remote Access or Mobile Access enabled; IKEv1 enabled for remote access; legacy Remote Access clients accepted; machine certificate not required [2]
Scores	CVSS 4.0 9.3 Critical (Check Point as CNA); CVSS 3.1 9.3 Critical (CISA ADP); SSVC: exploitation active, automatable yes, technical impact total [4]
Disclosed	8 Jun 2026: CVE published 11:07 UTC (reserved 7 Jun 09:42 UTC); NVD received it 12:16 [4] [6]
Fixed	Jumbo Hotfix Accumulators R82.10 Take 24, R82 Take 107, R81.20 Take 146, R81.10 Take 187; Spark R82.00.10 Build 998002216 and R81.10.17 Build 996004901 [2]
KEV	Added 8 Jun 2026, due 11 Jun 2026; known ransomware campaign use: Known [7]
First seen	7 May 2026, by Check Point's own account [1]
Actor	One case tied to a Qilin ransomware affiliate; financially motivated, medium confidence (vendor assessment) [1]
Victims	"A few dozen targeted organizations globally"; no names, sectors or exact count [1]

Key findings

- **The exposure window opened a month before the fix.** Exploitation began on 7 May; the hotfix shipped on 8 June [1] (**Confirmed**). The vendor's hunting window starts on 7 May for that reason [1] [2] (**Confirmed**).
- **Configuration decided exposure.** A vulnerable version was only exposed if all four conditions held [2] (**Confirmed**). Any one of the three documented configuration changes breaks the chain, though on locally managed Spark neither the older-clients option nor the machine certificate option applies, so IKEv2-only is the only configuration control there, and IKEv2 on Spark R81.10.X needs the StrongSWAN client (**Inferred** from [2]).
- **A third party reproduced it within four days.** watchTowr Labs reproduced the bypass on R82.10 JHF Take 19 on 12 June and confirmed that the hotfix rejects it [8] (**Demonstrated**).
- **Filtering the IKE ports is not enough.** watchTowr reports that the bypass also works over TCP 443 when UDP 500 and 4500 are filtered [8] (**Demonstrated**).
- **The ransomware link is narrow but real.** One case with confirmed post-compromise activity tied to a Qilin affiliate; the actor-level Qilin link is a medium-confidence vendor assessment [1] (**Reported**). Even so, CISA's KEV entry marks ransomware use as Known [7] (**Confirmed**).
- **Old appliances are stuck.** R80.40, R81 and Spark R80.20.X are affected and sk185033 lists no fix for them [2] (**Confirmed**). For those releases the configuration changes are the only control (**Inferred**).

Top recommendations

1. Install the recommended Jumbo Hotfix Accumulator, or the standalone hotfix for your take, on every gateway running Remote Access or Mobile Access. For centrally managed Spark appliances, update the management server with sk184766 first [2] (**Confirmed** as the vendor's direction).
2. Where you cannot patch today, close the chain in configuration. Clear "Allow older clients to connect", set remote access to IKEv2 only, or make machine certificate authentication mandatory [2] (**Confirmed**). On locally managed Spark, neither the older-clients option nor the machine certificate option applies, so IKEv2-only is the only configuration control there, and IKEv2 on R81.10.X needs the StrongSWAN client [2] (**Confirmed**).
3. Do not count the IPS protection named for this CVE as a fix. Check Point says it gives visibility only [2] (**Confirmed**).
4. Hunt back to 7 May 2026. Look for completed IKEv1 Quick Mode exchanges ("Key Install" events) from users or source addresses you do not recognize, from before you patched, and check the vendor's indicator list [1] [2] (**Confirmed**).
5. Plan the exit from R80.40, R81 and Spark R80.20.X, which have no listed fix [2] (**Confirmed**), and treat a hit as a possible ransomware precursor [1] [7] (**Inferred**).

Scope and method

This brief covers CVE-2026-50751 from first exploitation in May 2026 to the record as it stood on 11 November 2026. It describes tradecraft at advisory level. No exploit steps, packet contents, attacker IP addresses or file hashes are reproduced; Check Point publishes its indicators in its advisory and sk185033 [1] [2].

Grade	Meaning in this study
Confirmed	Stated in a primary record opened for this study: Check Point's advisory and support articles, the CVE, NVD and KEV records, and government advisories
Reported	A vendor's own assessment that no other source can test (victim counts, attribution at stated confidence), or a news report
Demonstrated	Reproduced by a third party (watchTowr Labs), or shown by this study's own check of the library's ATT&CK, CWE, CAPEC and D3FEND data files
Inferred	This study's own reasoning from cited facts, labelled where it appears

Not checked: the hunting-guide PDF that sk185033 references, national CERT advisories other than the Canadian Centre for Cyber Security and CERT-EU, regulator filings and victim statements. No victim has been named publicly in any source opened for this study.

Part 1: what happened

Date	Event	Sources	Grade
30 May 2024	CVE-2024-24919, an earlier Check Point gateway flaw (CWE-200), enters KEV; ransomware use Known	[7]	Confirmed
7 May 2026	Earliest exploitation Check Point observed; start of the attacker indicator window	[1] [2]	Confirmed
29 May 2026	KEV adds the PAN-OS authentication bypass CVE-2026-0257, ransomware use Known (a news report gives 13 May)	[7] [13]	Confirmed / Reported
Early Jun 2026	Exploitation attempts increase	[1]	Confirmed
4 Jun 2026	Check Point Research begins investigating suspicious activity; sk185033 created	[1] [2]	Confirmed
7 Jun 2026	CVE-2026-50751 reserved (09:42 UTC); sk185035 created for the companion CVE-2026-50752	[3] [4]	Confirmed
8 Jun 2026	CVE published by Check Point as CNA (11:07 UTC); hotfix announcement; NVD receives the record (12:16)	[1] [4] [6]	Confirmed
8 Jun 2026	CISA adds the CVE to KEV, due 11 Jun; NVD logs the KEV update at 22:00. The Canadian Centre issues AV26-559	[6] [7] [11]	Confirmed
9 Jun 2026	NVD initial analysis with CPE configurations; Check Point adds indicators; AV26-559 updated to note the KEV entry	[1] [6] [11]	Confirmed
10 Jun 2026	Check Point adds indicators	[1]	Confirmed
11 Jun 2026	KEV due date; more indicators; sk185033 adds R81.10 JHF Take 187	[1] [2] [7]	Confirmed
12 Jun 2026	watchTowr Labs publishes its reproduction and analysis	[8]	Demonstrated
13 Jun 2026	sk185033 adds attacker addresses and a section on identifying hits on the IPS signature	[2]	Confirmed
14 Jun 2026	sk185033 adds hotfixes for R82 Takes 60 and 44	[2]	Confirmed
15 Jun 2026	sk185033 adds JHF R82.10 Take 24, R82 Take 107 and R81.20 Take 146; the CPR weekly report records active exploitation and the Qilin case	[2] [9]	Confirmed / Reported
17 Jun 2026	The CNA adds affected-version data; CISA ADP adds its SSVC decision	[6]	Confirmed
22 Jul 2026	A later Check Point flaw, CVE-2026-16232 (SmartConsole), enters KEV	[7]	Confirmed
4 Aug 2026	SSVC changed; NVD record last modified	[5] [6]	Confirmed

Date	Event	Sources	Grade
10 Sep 2026	CERT-EU 2026-012 covers CVE-2026-85102 and CVE-2026-85103 in Check Point VPN; it does not mention CVE-2026-50751	[12]	Confirmed
22 Sep 2026	CVE-2026-85102 and CVE-2026-93616 enter KEV with BOD 26-04 forensic triage marked Yes	[7]	Confirmed
24 Sep 2026	sk185033 last modified	[2]	Confirmed
20 Oct 2026	News report of Unit 42 research naming Qilin (Spikey Scorpius) among operators exploiting PAN-OS CVE-2026-0257	[13]	Reported

The Intelligence Hub feed indexes the KEV row (8 June) and the watchTowr post (12 June) for this CVE [15] (**Confirmed**).

Discrepancies in the record

- **End-of-support fixes.** watchTowr says end-of-support versions get no hotfix [8] (**Reported**). sk185033 lists R81.10 among the end-of-support releases yet names R81.10 JHF Take 187 as a fix; it lists nothing for R80.40, R81 or Spark R80.20.X [2] (**Confirmed**). The vendor's fix list is the authority here (**Inferred**).
- **The weakness class.** The CNA, NVD and KEV all carry CWE-287 [4] [5] [7] (**Confirmed**). watchTowr labels it CWE-1337 in its own framing, and that is not the CNA's assignment [8] (**Reported**).
- **The victim count.** The vendor says "a few dozen" [1]. No other source offers a count, so the figure cannot be tested (**Reported**).

Part 2: the technical record

The flaw, at advisory level. IKEv1 is the older key exchange, which Check Point calls deprecated, that Remote Access VPN clients can use to set up a tunnel [1] [4] (**Confirmed**). Check Point's CNA description calls the bug a logic flow weakness in certificate validation in that exchange. It lets an unauthenticated remote attacker skip user authentication and open a remote access VPN connection without a valid password [4] (**Confirmed**). watchTowr describes the root cause as the client deciding how thoroughly its own credentials are checked [8] (**Reported**, its framing). In its reading of the patch, the fix stops the gateway trusting a client-supplied value that controlled whether certificate proof was checked [8] (**Demonstrated**). watchTowr also reports that the legacy username and password (XAUTH) mode could not be bypassed [8] (**Demonstrated**).

Scores. Check Point scores it CVSS 4.0 9.3 Critical (AV:N/AC:L/AT:N/PR:N/UI:N/VC:H/VI:H/VA:L/SC:N/SI:N/SA:N). CISA's ADP scores it CVSS 3.1 9.3 Critical (AV:N/AC:L/PR:N/UI:N/S:C/C:H/I:L/A:N) and records SSVC as exploitation active, automatable yes, technical impact total [4] (**Confirmed**).

Who was exposed. Version alone did not decide exposure. A gateway was vulnerable only if all four conditions held: Remote Access or Mobile Access enabled, IKEv1 enabled for remote access, legacy Remote Access clients accepted, and no machine certificate required [2] (**Confirmed**).

Line	Affected	Recommended fix
Quantum Security Gateway R82.10	JHF Take 19 or below	JHF Take 24 (standalone hotfixes for earlier takes)
R82	Take 103 or below	JHF Take 107 (standalone hotfixes for earlier takes, including Takes 60 and 44)
R81.20	Take 141 or below	JHF Take 146 (standalone hotfixes for earlier takes)
R81.10 (end of support)	Affected	JHF Take 187
R81, R80.40 (end of support)	Affected	None listed
Spark R82.00.X, R81.10.X	Affected	R82.00.10 Build 998002216; R81.10.17 Build 996004901
Spark R80.20.X (end of support)	Affected	None listed

Source for the table: sk185033 [2] (**Confirmed**). Centrally managed Spark appliances need the certificate and CRL validation fix in sk184766 on the management server before the Spark builds are installed [2] (**Confirmed**).

What the bypass gives. Check Point says an attacker who gets in still needs more activity to reach internal resources or escalate privileges [1] (**Confirmed**). The flaw opens a VPN session; it does not by itself hand over the gateway or the network behind it (**Inferred** from [1]).

The companion flaw. CVE-2026-50752 (sk185035) is an IKEv1 site-to-site certificate validation weakness. Where certificate authentication is used, a man-in-the-middle may be able to intercept or modify tunnel traffic. It is rated CWE-295, CVSS 7.4. Check Point found it in an extended internal review with its BLAST platform [1]. It has the same affected versions and fixes, is mitigated by IKEv2-only communities, and has not been exploited or added to KEV [3] [10] (**Confirmed**).

Part 3: who and why

What Check Point says. One case had confirmed post-compromise activity linked to a Qilin ransomware affiliate [1] (**Reported**). Check Point assesses, with medium confidence, that the actor is financially motivated and uses Qilin ransomware [1] (**Reported**). Check Point's actor profile adds these points [1] (**Reported**):

- Check Point believes the actor's infrastructure is also being used to exploit other vendors' VPN flaws, such as those published by Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet and F5.
- It may communicate over Tox.
- It ran dedicated VPS infrastructure at Kaupo Cloud HK, Shock Hosting and Vultr, sometimes geolocated in the victim's region. Check Point's example is Taiwan-geolocated infrastructure used against Taiwanese organizations.
- After access, attempts to download malicious ELF files from actor-controlled infrastructure showed an attributional overlap with Qilin Linux ransomware binaries.

The Check Point Research weekly report of 15 June repeats the account [9] (**Reported**). None of this should be stated more strongly than the vendor states it: one confirmed case, medium confidence.

What ATT&CK records. Qilin is ATT&CK software S1242 (alias Agenda), a ransomware-as-a-service operation active since at least 2022. ATT&CK names Water Galura (G1050) as its operators [14] [16] (**Confirmed**). Check Point names an affiliate, not Water Galura [1] (**Confirmed**), and no source opened here ties Water Galura itself to this CVE (**Inferred**).

The wider pattern. A news report of Unit 42 research names Qilin (tracked by Unit 42 as Spikey Scorpius) among the ransomware operators exploiting the PAN-OS authentication bypass CVE-2026-0257 [13] (**Reported**). The PAN-OS GlobalProtect authentication bypass study is the home for that flaw and the Qilin and INC activity tied to it. KEV marks that CVE's ransomware use as Known [7] (**Confirmed**). Taken with Check Point's belief that the actor's infrastructure is exploiting other vendors' VPN flaws, the record points to affiliates working through edge VPN bugs as an access route (**Inferred**).

Why. Check Point's motive assessment is financial [1] (**Reported**). KEV's ransomware flag is CISA's designation [7] (**Confirmed**). No source says what data was taken or whether anyone was encrypted.

Part 4: impact and response

Victims and scale. Check Point says exploitation was limited to "a few dozen targeted organizations globally" [1] (**Reported**). It names no victims or sectors. Its infrastructure example puts Taiwanese organizations among the targets [1] (**Confirmed** as the vendor's statement).

The vendor record. Check Point began investigating on 4 June after seeing suspicious activity, and shipped fixes four days later [1] (**Confirmed**). Over the next week it extended its indicator list three times (9, 10 and 11 June) and revised sk185033 almost daily: R81.10 JHF Take 187 on 11 June, attacker addresses and IPS identification on 13 June, R82 Take 60 and 44 hotfixes on 14 June, and the recommended accumulators on 15 June [1] [2] (**Confirmed**). The advisory's author is Lotem Finkelstein, VP Research at Check Point Research [1] (**Confirmed**).

The government record. CISA added the CVE to KEV on 8 June, the day it was published, with a due date of 11 June. Ransomware use is marked Known and the weakness is CWE-287. The required action is to apply mitigations per vendor instructions, follow BOD 22-01 guidance for cloud services, or discontinue use [7] (**Confirmed**). The Canadian Centre for Cyber Security issued AV26-559 on 8 June and updated it on 9 June to note the KEV addition; it says Check Point observed active exploitation [11] (**Confirmed**). CERT-EU's September advisory on later Check Point VPN flaws does not cover this CVE [12] (**Confirmed**). Other national CERTs: not checked.

The vendor's later run. CVE-2026-16232 (SmartConsole) entered KEV on 22 July, and CVE-2026-85102 and CVE-2026-93616 on 22 September with BOD 26-04 forensic triage marked Yes [7] (**Confirmed**). An earlier Check Point gateway flaw, CVE-2024-24919 (information disclosure, CWE-200, KEV 30 May 2024 with ransomware use Known), is covered in Threat Actors: Iran (AA24-241A, Pioneer Kitten) and the Healthcare Threat Watchlist [7] (**Confirmed**).

Part 5: the defender and vulnerability-management view

Inventory the configuration, not just the version. A version scan says which gateways could be hit. Only the four settings say which ones were exposed [2] (**Confirmed** facts; triage reading **Inferred**). Record per gateway whether IKEv1 is on for remote access, whether older clients are allowed, and whether machine certificates are mandatory (**Inferred**).

The three-day clock. KEV allowed three days [7] (**Confirmed**). The recommended accumulators for R82.10, R82 and R81.20 arrived on 15 June, after the due date; before then the fix was standalone hotfixes or configuration [2] (**Confirmed**). A team working to the KEV date had to close the configuration first and patch second (**Inferred**).

Do not lean on the edge controls. The IPS protection detects and does not remediate [2] (**Confirmed**). Port filtering on UDP 500 and 4500 does not close the path because TCP 443 works too [8] (**Demonstrated**). And geolocation-based logon review is weaker here, because the actor sometimes used infrastructure in the victim's own region [1] (**Reported**; the effect on detection **Inferred**).

Hunt as if patched late. Search from 7 May 2026, or the last 60 days, for the vendor's listed addresses. Treat IKEv1 Quick Mode completion ("Key Install") events from before patching as suspicious [2] (**Confirmed**). watchTowr released a detection artefact generator to help test detections [8] (**Demonstrated**). A hit means a VPN session existed; the next question is what that session reached [1] (**Inferred**).

Retire the deprecated path. IKEv1 is described by the vendor as deprecated, and both June flaws live in it [1] [3] [4] (**Confirmed**). Moving remote access and site-to-site communities to IKEv2 mitigates both [2] [3] (**Confirmed**).

What is overstated and what is understated

- **Overstated:** "authentication bypass" read as gateway takeover or mass exploitation. The vendor requires four configuration conditions, says further activity is needed after access, and reports a few dozen targeted organizations [1] [2] (**Inferred** reading of **Confirmed** facts). The Qilin link rests on one case at medium confidence [1] (**Reported**).
- **Understated:** that exploitation ran a month before disclosure [1]; that KEV allowed three days and marks ransomware use Known [7]; and that R80.40, R81 and Spark R80.20.X are affected with no listed fix [2] (**Confirmed**; the weighting **Inferred**).

MITRE mappings

This Part binds the verified record to MITRE ATT&CK v20.0 Enterprise, CWE, CAPEC and D3FEND. Names and tactics come from the library's `data/attack/technique_profiles.jsonl`, `software.jsonl`, `groups.jsonl`, `technique_to_d3fend.jsonl`, `d3fend_countermeasures.jsonl` and `data/weaknesses/` files [16] (**Demonstrated**). No source names ATT&CK technique ids; each row is this study's mapping (**Inferred**). No ATT&CK for ICS table applies: no source describes an industrial victim or effect.

Groups, software and campaigns

Object	Name	Bound as	Sources
S1242	Qilin	The ransomware tied to the one confirmed post-compromise case, via an affiliate (vendor assessment, medium confidence)	[1] [9] [14]
G1050	Water Galura	Context only: ATT&CK's named operators of Qilin; no source ties them to this CVE	[14] [16]

No campaign object is bound: the library's `campaigns.jsonl` holds no entry for this CVE or for Qilin [16] (**Demonstrated**).

ATT&CK Enterprise techniques

ID	Name	Tactic(s)	Dated event or report	Sources
T1190	Exploit Public-Facing Application	Initial Access	IKEv1 authentication bypass on internet-facing gateways, from 7 May (advisory and KEV, 8 Jun)	[1] [2] [4] [7]
T1133	External Remote Services	Persistence, Initial Access	Remote access VPN connection set up without a valid password (CVE record, 8 Jun)	[4]
T1583.003	Virtual Private Server	Resource Development	Dedicated VPS at three hosting providers, sometimes in the victim's region (vendor assessment, 8 Jun)	[1]
T1105	Ingress Tool Transfer	Command and Control	Post-access ELF download attempts from actor infrastructure, overlapping Qilin Linux ransomware binaries (vendor assessment, 8 Jun)	[1]

Fit notes (**Inferred**): T1133 fits because the bypass yields a working remote access VPN session. Valid Accounts (T1078) is not bound, because the record says the session opens without a valid password and does not say whose identity it carries. T1105 rests on download attempts; no source says a payload ran. Data Encrypted for Impact (T1486) is not bound: no source describes encryption in any victim. Tox use is stated as possible, so no communication technique is bound for it.

CWE and CAPEC

CWE	Name	Where it is assigned	Sources
CWE-287	Improper Authentication	CVE-2026-50751 (Check Point, NVD, KEV)	[4] [5] [7]
CWE-295	Improper Certificate Validation	CVE-2026-50752, the site-to-site companion (Check Point)	[3] [10]
CWE-200	Exposure of Sensitive Information to an Unauthorized Actor	CVE-2024-24919, the 2024 predecessor (KEV)	[7]

CAPEC	Name	Via	Where it meets the record
CAPEC-115	Authentication Bypass	CWE-287	VPN session without a valid password [4] (**Inferred** fit)
CAPEC-22	Exploiting Trust in Client	CWE-287	The gateway trusted a client-supplied value about how to check credentials [8] (**Inferred** fit)

CAPEC	Name	Via	Where it meets the record
CAPEC-94	Adversary in the Middle (AiTM)	CWE-287 in the library (CVE-2026-50752 carries CWE-295)	Interception of site-to-site tunnels in the companion flaw [3] (**Inferred** fit)

The library relates CWE-287 to further CAPEC entries (for example CAPEC-114, CAPEC-151 and CAPEC-593) and CWE-295 to CAPEC-459 and CAPEC-475; none of those meets this record as closely [16] (**Demonstrated**). No source assigns a CAPEC id. See the CWE Reference and CAPEC Reference.

D3FEND countermeasures

D3FEND countermeasure	Techniques the library maps it to (from this study)	Where it meets the record
Network Traffic Signature Analysis	T1190, T1105	The IPS protection for the CVE, detection only [2]
Inbound Traffic Filtering	T1190	Blocking the vendor's listed addresses; UDP port filtering alone fails because TCP 443 works [2] [8] (**Inferred** fit)
User Geolocation Logon Pattern Analysis	T1190, T1105	Weakened by in-region VPS [1] (**Inferred**)
Session Termination	T1133	Ending VPN sessions from unrecognized users found in the hunt [2] (**Inferred** fit)
Outbound Traffic Filtering	T1105	Blocking the ELF downloads [1] (**Inferred** fit)

The library relates no D3FEND countermeasure to T1583.003 [16] (**Demonstrated**). The vendor's main controls correspond to Software Update (the hotfixes) and Certificate-based Authentication (mandatory machine certificates). The library does not relate either to these techniques [2] [16] (**Demonstrated** for the data check). See the D3FEND Reference.

Navigator layer

The study's techniques are saved as an ATT&CK Navigator layer pinned to ATT&CK v20, `navigator/library-layers/check-point-vpn-cve-2026-50751.json` (open in Navigator), listed on the Navigator layers page. Scores: 75 for behavior in Check Point's advisory, the CVE record or KEV; 50 for behavior from the vendor's actor profile. Each technique's comment names its source numbers.

Cross-cutting themes

- **Deprecated protocols stay live.** Both June flaws sit in IKEv1, which the vendor calls deprecated [1] [3] [4] (**Confirmed**). Backward compatibility for older clients was one of the four conditions [2] (**Confirmed**).
- **Disclosure is not the start of the clock.** A month of exploitation came before the advisory [1] (**Confirmed**). Hunting windows should start at first exploitation, not at the patch date (**Inferred**).
- **Edge VPNs feed ransomware access.** KEV marks ransomware use Known for this CVE, for CVE-2024-24919 and for PAN-OS CVE-2026-0257 [7] (**Confirmed**). See the Edge Device Security Reference and Ransomware Defense Reference.

- **The client must not grade its own exam.** watchTowr's framing, a client deciding how it is checked, is a design lesson for any authentication protocol [8] (**Demonstrated**; the general lesson **Inferred**).
- **End of support is a security state.** Appliances past support were affected and some have no fix [2] (**Confirmed**).

Sources

All sources were opened on 11 November 2026.

#	Source	URL	Opened	Grade
1	Check Point blog, Security Advisory: Action Required: Active Exploitation of Check Point VPN Authentication Bypass (CVE-2026-50751), Lotem Finkelstein, 8 Jun 2026, indicators added to 11 Jun 2026	blog.checkpoint.com/security/check-point-releases-important-hotfix-...	2026-11-11	Confirmed (attribution and counts Reported)
2	Check Point support article sk185033 (CVE-2026-50751), created 4 Jun 2026, last modified 24 Sep 2026	support.checkpoint.com/results/sk/sk185033	2026-11-11	Confirmed
3	Check Point support article sk185035 (CVE-2026-50752), created 7 Jun 2026	support.checkpoint.com/results/sk/sk185035	2026-11-11	Confirmed
4	CVE Program record CVE-2026-50751 (CNA Check Point, with CISA ADP)	cveawg.mitre.org/api/cve/CVE-2026-50751	2026-11-11	Confirmed
5	NVD, CVE-2026-50751, 2.0 API record	services.nvd.nist.gov/rest/json/cves/2.0?cveId=CVE-2026-50751	2026-11-11	Confirmed
6	NVD, CVE-2026-50751 change history	services.nvd.nist.gov/rest/json/cvehistory/2.0?cveId=CVE-2026-50751	2026-11-11	Confirmed
7	CISA, Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog JSON, catalog version 2026.11.10 (rows CVE-2026-50751, CVE-2024-24919, CVE-2026-0257, CVE-2026-16232, CVE-2026-85102, CVE-2026-93616); entry page for CVE-2026-50751 also opened	cisa.gov/sites/default/files/feeds/known_exploited_vulnerabilities.json	2026-11-11	Confirmed
8	watchTowr Labs, Marking Your Own Homework: Check Point Remote Access VPN IKEv1 Authentication Bypass (CVE-2026-50751), 12 Jun 2026	labs.watchtowr.com/marking-your-own-homework-...	2026-11-11	Demonstrated
9	Check Point Research, 15th June Threat Intelligence Report, 15 Jun 2026	research.checkpoint.com/2026/15th-june-threat-intelligence-report/	2026-11-11	Reported
10	CVE Program record CVE-2026-50752 (CNA Check Point)	cveawg.mitre.org/api/cve/CVE-2026-50752	2026-11-11	Confirmed
11	Canadian Centre for Cyber Security, Check Point security advisory AV26-559, 8 Jun 2026, updated 9 Jun 2026	cyber.gc.ca/en/alerts-advisories/check-point-security-advisory-av26-559	2026-11-11	Confirmed
12	CERT-EU, Security Advisory 2026-012, 10 Sep 2026	cert.europa.eu/publications/security-advisories/2026-012/	2026-11-11	Confirmed

#	Source	URL	Opened	Grade
13	The Hacker News, Qilin and INC ransomware groups exploit PAN-OS flaw, 20 Oct 2026 (reporting Unit 42)	thehackernews.com/2026/10/qilin-and-inc-ransomware-groups-exploit.html	2026-11-11	Reported
14	MITRE ATT&CK, Software S1242 Qilin	attack.mitre.org/software/S1242	2026-11-11	Confirmed
15	Team Star Wolf Intelligence Hub feed (index only)	teamstarwolf.github.io/intelligence-hub/data/feed.json	2026-11-11	Confirmed
16	TeamStarWolf library data: `data/attack/technique_profiles.jsonl`, `software.jsonl`, `groups.jsonl`, `campaigns.jsonl`, `technique_to_d3fend.jsonl`, `d3fend_countermeasures.jsonl` (ATT&CK v20.0), and `data/weaknesses/cwe.jsonl` and `capec.jsonl`	github.com/TeamStarWolf/TeamStarWolf/tree/main/data/attack	2026-11-11	Demonstrated

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The terms for every MITRE dataset used here are recorded in THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md.

Related references

- Threat Actors: Iran, Healthcare Threat Watchlist, Ransomware Ecosystem, The Year 2024 in Intrusions, The Year 2026 in Intrusions, Timeline
- Other 2026 edge and remote-access studies: The PAN-OS GlobalProtect authentication bypass, The FortiCloud SSO authentication bypass, The Cisco Catalyst SD-WAN authentication bypass, The Citrix NetScaler zero-days, The Ivanti Connect Secure zero-day chain, The BeyondTrust Remote Support and PRA command injection
- Threat Actors, Malware Families, Notable Incidents
- CVE Reference, CWE Reference, CAPEC Reference, D3FEND Reference
- Edge Device Security Reference, Check Point, Ransomware Defense Reference, Identity Security Reference, Vulnerability Management Reference, Vulnerability Prioritization Reference
- Software and groups: S1242 Qilin, G1050 Water Galura
- Techniques: T1190 Exploit Public-Facing Application, T1133 External Remote Services, T1583.003 Virtual Private Server, T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer
- CAPEC: CAPEC-115, CAPEC-22, CAPEC-94
- Navigator layers, including this study's layer, check-point-vpn-cve-2026-50751.json

- The Team Star Wolf Intelligence Hub
- All case studies